

OpenBSD W^X story

Alireza Arzehgar

August 7, 2025

- UNIX - 1969

- UNIX - 1969
- BSD - 1978

- UNIX - 1969
- BSD - 1978
- NetBSD - 1993 (Founders: Chris, Theo, Adam, Charles)

- UNIX - 1969
- BSD - 1978
- NetBSD - 1993 (Founders: Chris, Theo, Adam, Charles)
- OpenBSD - 1995 (Founder: Theo de Raadt)

- Conferences

- Conferences
- Papers

- Conferences
- Papers
- Releases

- Conferences
- Papers
- Releases
- Hackathons

- Conferences
- Papers
- Releases
- Hackathons
- Artwork

- Conferences
- Papers
- Releases
- Hackathons
- Artwork
- Songs

3.3: Puff the Barbarian



- XOR

- XOR
- Application Execution

- XOR
- Application Execution
- Buffer Overflow

- XOR
- Application Execution
- Buffer Overflow
- Memory Protection

- XOR
- Application Execution
- Buffer Overflow
- Memory Protection
- MMU

Memory Management Unit (MMU)

Memory Management Unit (MMU)

- Memory Isolation

Memory Management Unit (MMU)

- Memory Isolation
- Virtual memory management

Memory Management Unit (MMU)

- Memory Isolation
- Virtual memory management
- Per-page execute bit permissions

$$W^X$$

UltraSPARC III vs. AMD Hammer

Open for discussion